

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 9 8 5

♥ K J 8 7 4

♦ —

♣ Q 9 8

♠ 6 2

♥ 5 3 2

♦ A K Q 7 6 4

♣ 4 2



♠ K 7 3

♥ Q 10

♦ J 10 9 5 2

♣ K 6 5

♠ A Q 4

♥ A 9 6

♦ 8 3

♣ A J 10 7 3

West

North

East

South

2♦

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠J

With 11 points and a beautiful 6-card suit this is the perfect hand for a Weak-2 opener. So you open 2♦. Partner responds 2NT.

Partner's 2NT bid is a standard response to a Weak 2-bid. You are expected to rebid your suit if you have a minimum (6-8 point) hand. Otherwise you are to bid an outside suit in which you hold a high card - this is called "showing a feature". And the final possibility is this one, where you have a solid suit, either A K Q x x x or A K J 10 x x. In this case you bid 3NT.

North would play 3NT.

South plays 3NT. West leads ♠J. East plays ♠K.

South plays 3NT. West leads ♠J. East plays ♠K.

Winner count: ♠ 2 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 3 : ♣ 1 : Total = 7

The ♠ lead assures you of two tricks in the suit. So you only need to create two more. If the ♦s split 3-2 (likely) you could get 3 extra tricks there. But there's a danger - if they split 4-1 you wouldn't have an entry to them. Well, you wouldn't have an entry unless you **DUCKED** the first ♦. Then a 4-1 split wouldn't prevent you from making 5 ♦ winners.

So you win the ♠A and lead the ♦3, planning to duck.

West shows out.

Make **PLAN B**, then

So you win the ♠A and lead the ♦3, planning to duck.

West shows out.

That's tough. No matter how you play them you can only get 3 ♦ winners. So you must turn elsewhere - elsewhere being the ♣ suit.

Win the ♦Q but don't play another ♦ yet, you need an entry back to dummy later. Instead, lead the ♣2 and finesse your ♣10. West will win with one of the high ♣s and probably return a ♠. You may as well take the ♠Q now. Play your ♦8 to dummy's ♦K, cash the ♦A, then play the ♣4, finessing your ♣J. Fortunately this wins and when you cash your ♣A both defenders follow. The rest of your clubs are good and you make an overtrick.

Sometimes you have to change your plan.

When the ♦s turned out to be 5-0 you had to get lucky. Your back-up Plan wasn't likely to work - it required the missing ♣ honors to be split, but also required a 3-3 ♣ split, not a likely outcome.

But there was no other choice so you have to try it.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 8 3

♥ 6 3

♦ A J 3

♣ K 10 7

♠ 6 5

♥ K 9

♦ 8 7 6 4 2

♣ A 8 5 3

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♠ 9 4

♥ Q 5 2

♦ Q 10 9

♣ Q J 9 6 2

♠ A K 7 2

♥ A J 10 8 7 4

♦ K 5

♣ 4

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

Pass

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

Lead: ♠ Q

You open 1 ♥, West overcalls 1 ♠ and partner passes.

You shouldn't let West steal from you so you will bid your ♥s again. You must decide between 2 ♥ and 3 ♥. Given that partner might have had a pretty decent hand yet still have to pass, you decide to go with 3 ♥. Partner bids 4 ♥.

South plays 4 ♥. West leads the ♠ Q.

South plays 4 ♥. West leads the ♠ Q.

Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 0 : Total = 5

Win the ♠ K, then enter dummy with the ♣ A and play another ♠ toward your ♠ A. You do this to prevent East ruffing your high ♠. Next you lead the ♠ 2 and ruff with dummy's ♥ K. Ruff a ♣ to get back to your hand and ruff the ♠ 7 with dummy's ♥ 9. East may over-ruff this, but only with a trump trick he was going to win anyway.

You will lose two ♦s and the ♥ Q but no more.

It is tempting to ruff the first ♠ with dummy's ♥ 9, hoping to sneak that through then ruff the second one with ♥ K.

The problem is that East would have over-ruffed the ♥ 9 and then played another ♥ and you would not have gotten to ruff either ♠,

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 3 2
♥ 9 5
♦ Q 8 7 2
♣ K Q 10 9

♠ J 9 8 5 4

♥ Q 6

♦ J 10 4

♣ A 7 2



♠ K 10 7 6

♥ 8 3 2

♦ K 6 5

♣ J 8 4

♠ A

♥ A K J 10 7 4

♦ A 9 3

♣ 6 5 3

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	1♠	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			
Lead: ♣K			

You respond 1♠, your 5-card Major. Partner jumps to 3♥.

Make your next bid.

Partner is showing 16-18 points and you have 9. Since he rebid ♥s he must have at least six of them you you know there is an 8-card fit. You bid 4♥.

North would play 4♥.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♣K.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♣K.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 2 : Total = 4

You might consider setting up dummy's ♠ suit for a discard but there are too few entries to make that work.

More promising is playing East to have at least one of the ♦ honors and taking two finesses in that suit. **BUT**, entries are still a problem. You can only reach dummy twice, once with the ♣A and once with the ♥Q, and you must play ♦s each time you are there.

Win the first trick with the ♣A and play the ♦J, letting it ride if East doesn't cover. West will win this trick and take two ♣s. He will probably then lead a ♠. You win your ♠A, play ♥A then a small ♥ to dummy's ♥Q. Now lead a ♦ and finesse with your ♦9. When this wins, pull trumps and claim.

Taking two finesses in ♦s will be successful whenever East holds the ♦K **OR** the ♦Q **OR** both the ♦K Q.

This will happen about 75% of the time, so the double finesse is a good Plan. And on this Deal it was the only plan available.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 4

♥ J 5

♦ 10 9 8

♣ A K 10 7 4

♠ A J 6 5 2

♥ 10 4

♦ Q 7 4 3

♣ J 6



♠ K Q 10 3

♥ 9 7 3

♦ K J 6 2

♣ 8 2

♠ 7

♥ A K Q 8 6 2

♦ A 5

♣ Q 9 5 3

West	North	East	South
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Pass

1 ♠

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

Lead: ♣ A

You respond with your 5-card Major, 1 ♠.

Partner jumps to 3 ♥.

With partner's 16-18 points you probably have enough strength for game.

With partner's six ♥s you have an 8-card fit.

So you bid 4 ♥.

North would play 4 ♥.

South plays 4 ♥. West leads ♣ A, ♣ K, ♣ 4. East plays ♣ 8 then ♣ 2.

South plays 4 ♥. West leads ♣ A, ♣ K, ♣ 4. East plays ♣ 8 then ♣ 2.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 3 : Total = 4

Suppose you discard a ♦ from dummy. If East doesn't ruff this ♣ 10 then your ♣ Q will win. You could then try to establish dummy's ♦ Q to discard your fourth ♣ on.

But you know that plan won't work because East **IS** going to ruff this ♣ if you discard. You only have one chance to make this contract, and that is the chance that East was not dealt the ♥ J. So you ruff with dummy's ♥ 10 and pray East doesn't over-ruff.

The prayer was answered, East did not hold the ♥ J.

So you won that trick and still had your ♣ Q to use after you pulled trumps.